AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII EXAMINATION

APRIL/ MAY 2018

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 05 minutes Marks: 60

AKU-EB May 2018 for Teaching & Learning Only

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are FOUR questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 3 offers TWO choices and Question 4 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   Use a black pencil for diagrams. DO NOT use coloured pencils.
   DO NOT use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only. DO NOT write outside the answer box.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 17 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and then answer all the questions that follow:

Why people prefer certain foods over others depends largely on a combination of taste and texture. While taste sensations are fairly well understood, scientists are just beginning to unravel the mystery of food texture.

Now, researchers at the Monell Chemical Senses Centre in Philadelphia (USA) have found that an enzyme in saliva called amylase, which breaks down starch into liquid, could play a key role in determining the appeal of various textures of food. A new genetic study shows that people produce strikingly different amounts of amylase, and that the more of the enzyme people have in their mouth, the faster they can liquefy starchy foods.

Scientists think this finding could help explain why people experience certain food items as creamy or slimy, sticky or watery, and that this perception could affect our preference for foods. For the numerous foods that contain starch, including pudding and sauces, what can feel just right to some people is experienced as too runny or not melting enough for others because they produce different amounts of the enzyme.

The ability to quickly break down starch, which is a type of carbohydrate, is only one part of the puzzle that determines what people like to eat. Taste preferences are driven by a complicated interaction between taste buds and other receptors in the mouth and nose, and the messages they send to the brain. Culture plays a role, as people tend to like foods that are familiar, says Rick Mattes, a food and nutrition professor.

Amylase and other enzymes in saliva could also help explain food texture preferences that are known to vary with age, Dr Breslin says. For instance, many young children dislike certain fruits because of a perceived sliminess — think of the inside of a tomato. But people's saliva-flow rate tends to slow with age, which might affect their ability to break down starch in the mouth and reduce sensations of sliminess.

Another factor in food preferences: people vary — probably based on genetics — in their ability to detect other textures, such as fat, bitter and sweet tastes. Valerie Duffy, a registered dietician, has shown in her research that adults with a gene that makes bitter tastes more intense consume fewer vegetables containing bitter compounds, such as kale or spinach.

But that genetic preference can be changed by repeatedly exposing the individual to the taste or by masking the bitterness, even at an early age, she has found. In a preliminary study with pre-schoolers, Dr Duffy's group added a sweet taste to balance out the bitterness of certain vegetables — less than half a teaspoon of sugar to a cup of broccoli or asparagus, for example, during cooking — and found that the children were more accepting of the greens. Even when the sweetness was removed, the children still liked the vegetables more than before because they had developed a positive association with them.

Source: Adapted from *The Science Behind Why We Love Ice Cream* by Shirley S. Wang

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a. Summarise Dr Valerie Duffy's findings mentioned in the last two paragraphs of the passage in no more than TWO sentences. (5 Marks)

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b. Ali is 5 years old and he hates the taste of peas. Whenever his mother gives him peas for lunch, he gives them to his friend Sarah who likes them.

i. With reference to the text, suggest any TWO possible reasons why Sarah likes peas but Ali does not. (2 Marks)

ii. With reference to the text, suggest ONE way in which Ali's mother can encourage him to eat his peas. (1 Mark)

c. Imagine yourself as the co-author of this article. Add any TWO details to the passage. (4 Marks)

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d. Relate a personal experience about food preferences to confirm or deny the findings of this passage. (5 Marks)

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Q.2. (Total 10 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and fill in each of the blanks with **ONE** suitable word.

Baked or fried, boiled or roasted, as chips or fries. At some point in your life, you have probably eaten a potato. Delicious, for sure, but, the fact is, potatoes have played a much more significant role in our history than just that of the dietary staple we have come to know and love today.
There are hundreds of different breeds of potatoes, and 1_____ turns out that beneath that yellow or brown or purple or red skin, they 2_____quite different chemistries.

Potato was first cultivated in South America and was 3_____ to Europe by the Spanish. Europeans simply didn't want to eat it as they considered potato dull and tasteless. So instead of consuming them, they 4_____ potatoes as decorative garden plants.

More than 200 years would pass before the potato caught on as a major food source throughout Europe, though even then, it was predominantly 5_____ by the lower classes. However, beginning around 1750, and thanks at least in part to the wide availability of inexpensive and nutritious potatoes, European peasants 6_____ greater food security no longer found themselves at the mercy of the regularly occurring grain famines of the time, and so their populations steadily grew.

As a result, the British, Dutch and German Empires rose on the backs of the growing groups of farmers, labourers, and soldiers, thus lifting the West to its place of world dominion.
However, not all European countries 7_____ empires. After the Irish adopted the potato, their population dramatically increased, as did their dependence on the tuber as a major food 8_____.

Aided by the influx of migrants, Europe then 9_____ a large, sustainable, and well-fed population who 10_____ capable of manning the emerging factories that would bring about our modern world via the Industrial Revolution. Hence, potato has played a significant role in the Industrial Revolution.

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Q.3. (Total 15 Marks)

Compose a formal piece of writing of around 250-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a** or **b**.

EITHER

a. A leading newspaper is seeking interns having high school/ intermediate degree to work as Editorial Assistants.

Job Requirements

The primary duties are reading numerous news reports that arrive each week from writers around the world, and fact-checking articles. Other duties include work on social media, research and clerical duties like typing and field visits.

Skills Needed:

The editorial assistant must have a sharp eye for detail; a strong sense of fresh arguments and good writing; research skills; a devotion to the highest standards of accuracy, precision and verification; ability to dive into unfamiliar material on deadline; discretion in handling sensitive editorial material; and a strong interest in opinion journalism.

Compose a resume and a cover letter in response to the above given advertisement.

OR

b. Pakistan's tourism industry was at its prime during the 1970s when the country received unprecedented amounts of foreign tourists. The main destinations were the Khyber Pass, Peshawar, Karachi, Lahore, Swat, Quetta, Gwadar and Rawalpindi. Due to several reasons, tourism has significantly declined in Pakistan.

Write a report for the Tourism Authority of Pakistan. In your report, discuss:

- factors that may have affected the decrease in tourism in Pakistan.
- what should be done by the government and the citizens to attract tourists to your area.
- views of public about this issue.
- areas around you that may be developed into tourist destinations.

Make your notes on the page given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 8, 9 and 10.

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Q.4. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 350-400 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b** or **c.**
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. A stereotype is any thought widely adopted about specific types of individuals or certain ways of behaving intended to represent the entire group of those individuals or behaviours as a whole. When people are categorised on some feature that they have like race, gender and religion; it is called stereotyping. One example of stereotyping is 'all Americans are overweight'.

Analyse the stereotypes that are present around you. In your essay, mention:

- whether stereotypes are positive or negative.
- examples of at least TWO stereotypes around you (Do NOT repeat the example mentioned in the question).
- whether the stereotypes mentioned by you are justified. Give reasons.

OR

b. The gender pay gap is the average difference between a man's and a woman's salaries. According to a report by World Economic Forum, despite significant advances in economic participation, opportunity and educational attainment by women in the past few decades, women on average earn less than men while working on same position and performing same tasks.

Mention your stance about the issue highlighted above. Should men and women be paid equal salaries when they work side by side performing the same task? Mention FOUR reasons for your stance.

OR

c. Snow leopard is a rare and beautiful animal which resides in the Northern Areas of Pakistan. Snow leopards frequently kill domestic goats and sheep which are farmer's precious resources. Farmers, hence, often end up killing snow leopards due to which snow leopard's population has diminished significantly. In this way, there is a perpetual human-wildlife conflict. Many Non-government organisations like Project Snow Leopard are working to conserve snow leopard population.

Write an argumentative essay about whether the population of snow leopards should be conserved. Give at least FOUR reasons for your answer.

Make your notes on the page given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 12, 13 and 14.

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END OF PAPER

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